

Operations on functions

Building new functions out of old ones, reading a graph, and the rules of logarithms.

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- 1 Adding and multiplying functions
 - 2 Reading a graph
 - 3 Composition of functions
 - 4 Inverses, and when one exists
 - 5 Finding an inverse
 - 6 The rules of logarithms
 - 7 Week 2 review quiz
-

Adding and multiplying functions

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 **Practise:** Quotients and sums of fractions · Add & subtract rational expressions (https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:rational-functions/x9e81a4f98389efdf:adding-and-subtracting-rational-expressions/e/adding_and_subtracting_rational_expressions_5)

 **Practise:** Products of functions · Multiply binomials (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:quadratics-multiplying-factoring/x2f8bb11595b61c86:multiply-binomial/e/multiply-binomials-coefficient>)

Khan has no lesson on $f + g$, $f - g$ and fg as such. These two are the same algebra on expressions, which is the closest it gets.

THE FIVE

$$(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x) \quad (fg)(x) = f(x)g(x)$$

and the same idea for the difference, the quotient, and a constant times a function.

- 1 **Do the operation one value at a time.** Whatever x is, work out $f(x)$ and $g(x)$, then combine those two numbers.
- 2 **The result is defined only where both are.** Intersect the two domains.
- 3 **A quotient also needs the bottom to be non-zero.** $(f/g)(x)$ needs $g(x) \neq 0$.
- 4 **The combination you will use constantly is profit.**

$$P(q) = R(q) - C(q)$$

- 5 **Cost usually splits into fixed plus variable.** The fixed part is what you pay at $q = 0$, so it is the y -intercept.

The Rivella Coffee case

The five operations

$$(f + g)(x) = f(x) + g(x) \quad (f - g)(x) = f(x) - g(x)$$

$$(fg)(x) = f(x)g(x) \quad \left(\frac{f}{g}\right)(x) = \frac{f(x)}{g(x)} \quad (cf)(x) = c \cdot f(x)$$

WORKED, WITH $F(X) = 3X - 1$ AND $G(X) = X^2 + 3X$

$$(f + g)(x) = x^2 + 6x - 1$$

$3x - 1 + x^2 + 3x$, collected.

$$(f - g)(x) = -x^2 - 1$$

$3x - 1 - x^2 - 3x$. The $3x$ terms cancel.

$$(fg)(x) = 3x^3 + 8x^2 - 3x$$

$(3x - 1)(x^2 + 3x)$, expanded.

$$\left(\frac{f}{g}\right)(x) = \frac{3x - 1}{x^2 + 3x}$$

Undefined where $x^2 + 3x = 0$, so at 0 and -3 .

$$\left(\frac{1}{2}f\right)(x) = \frac{3}{2}x - \frac{1}{2}$$

A constant multiplies every term.

Why it matters: profit

$$P(q) = R(q) - C(q)$$

WATCH OUT

- Put the second function in brackets before subtracting, or the signs of its later terms survive when they should not.
- A quotient is undefined wherever the bottom function is zero, even where the top is perfectly fine.
- The combination is only defined where both originals are. Intersect the domains.

PRACTICE · ADDING AND MULTIPLYING FUNCTIONS

- Let $f(x) = x^2 + 4$, $g(x) = 10x$ and $h(x) = \sqrt{x + 1}$. Compute $(f - g + h)(3)$.
- Rivella Coffee has fixed costs $f(q) = 10\,000$, materials $g(q) = 200q$ and salaries $h(q) = 5q^2$. Total cost is $C = f + g + h$. What is $C(40)$, in CHF?
- With $f(x) = 3x - 1$ and $g(x) = x^2 + 3x$, what is $(f - g)(x)$?
 - $-x^2 - 1$
 - $-x^2 + 6x - 1$
 - $x^2 + 1$
 - $x^2 + 6x - 1$
- With $f(x) = 3x - 1$ and $g(x) = x^2 + 3x$, what is $(f \cdot g)(2)$?

5. With $f(x) = 3x - 1$ and $g(x) = x^2 + 3x$, what is the domain of $\left(\frac{f}{g}\right)(x)$?

A. $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0, -3\}$

B. $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0, 3\}$

C. $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{-3\}$

D. $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0, -3, \frac{1}{3}\}$

6. $f(x) = x^2 + 4$ is defined on all of $\mathbb{R}$, and $h(x) = \sqrt{x + 1}$ is defined for $x \geq -1$. What is the domain of $f + h$?

A. $x \geq -1$

B. $\mathbb{R}$

C. $x > -1$

D. $x \geq 1$

Reading a graph

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► **Watch:** Both intercepts · x-intercepts and y-intercepts (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:linear-equations-graphs/x2f8bb11595b61c86:x-intercepts-and-y-intercepts/v/introduction-to-intercepts>)

► **Watch:** Intercepts of a parabola · Interpret a quadratic graph (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:quadratic-functions-equations/x2f8bb11595b61c86:intro-parabolas/v/interpret-a-quadratic-graph>)

≡ **Read:** Intercepts of lines review (x-intercepts and y-intercepts) (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:linear-equations-graphs/x2f8bb11595b61c86:x-intercepts-and-y-intercepts/a/intercepts-of-lines-review-x-intercepts-and-y-intercepts>)

✍ **Practise:** From the formula · Intercepts from an equation (https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:linear-equations-graphs/x2f8bb11595b61c86:x-intercepts-and-y-intercepts/e/solving_for_the_x-intercept)

✍ **Practise:** Intercepts from a graph (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:linear-equations-graphs/x2f8bb11595b61c86:x-intercepts-and-y-intercepts/e/linear-function-intercepts>)

- 1 The y-intercept is the value at zero. Put $x = 0$. There is at most one.
- 2 The x-intercepts are where the function is zero. Solve $f(x) = 0$. There may be several, or none.
- 3 Plot the intercepts first, then enough points to see the shape.
- 4 In a business question the intercepts mean something. The y-intercept is usually a fixed cost. An x-intercept is usually break-even.
- 5 A vertical line is not a function. $x = 3$ is a perfectly good line and has no y to be a function of x.

The method

WORKED: $Y = 2X + 3$

$$y = 0 \rightarrow 0 = 2x + 3$$

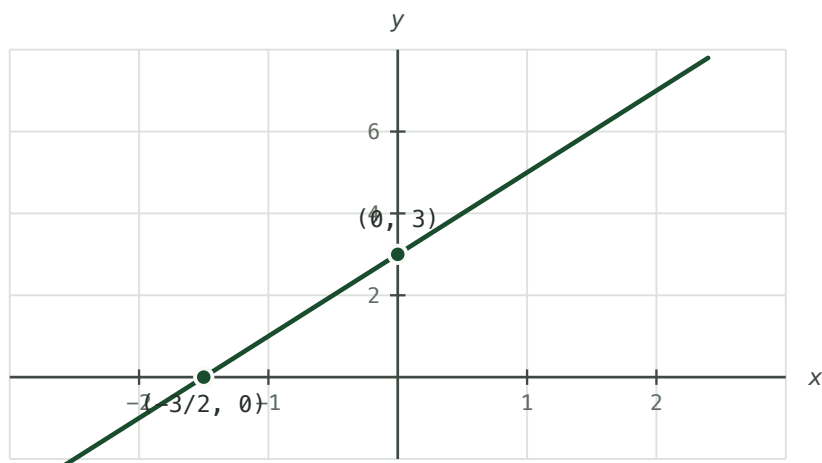
Set y to zero for the x-intercept.

$$x = -\frac{3}{2}$$

One x-intercept.

$$x = 0 \rightarrow y = 2(0) + 3 = 3$$

Set x to zero for the y-intercept.



$y = 2x + 3$. It crosses the vertical axis at 3 and the horizontal axis at $-3/2$.

A SECOND: $x = 3$

$x = 3$

A vertical line.

no y-intercept

Because x can never be 0 on this graph.

Break-even is an x-intercept

WATCH OUT

- A zero denominator is not an x-intercept. It is a break in the curve.
- For a quadratic, a negative discriminant means no x-intercept at all, and that is a complete answer.
- Only the numerator can make a fraction zero, so solve the numerator and then check the value is allowed.

PRACTICE · READING A GRAPH

1. Give the y-intercept of $y = 2x - 6$ as a point.
2. What are the x-intercepts of $y = x^2 - 5x + 6$?
 - A. (2, 0) and (3, 0)
 - B. (0, 2) and (0, 3)
 - C. (-2, 0) and (-3, 0)
 - D. (0, 6)

3. The equation $y = f(x)$ defines a function. At most how many y-intercepts can its graph have?

4. How many y-intercepts does $9x^2 + 4y^2 = 25$ have, and where?

A. two: $(0, \frac{5}{2})$ and $(0, -\frac{5}{2})$

B. one: $(0, \frac{5}{2})$

C. one: $(0, 25)$

D. two: $(\frac{5}{3}, 0)$ and $(-\frac{5}{3}, 0)$

5. What are the x-intercepts of $y = \frac{x^2 - 9}{x - 2}$?

A. $(-3, 0)$ and $(3, 0)$

B. $(3, 0)$ only

C. $(2, 0)$

D. $(0, \frac{9}{2})$

6. What is the y-coordinate of the y-intercept of $y = \frac{x^2 - 9}{x - 2}$?

Composition of functions

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► **Watch:** What a composite is · Composing functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composing/v/function-composition>)

► **Watch:** At a number · Evaluating composite functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composing/v/evaluating-composite-functions>)

≡ **Read:** The definition · Intro to composing functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composing/a/introduction-to-function-composition>)

✍ **Practise:** At a number · Evaluate composite functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composing/e/evaluate-composite-functions-from-formulas>)

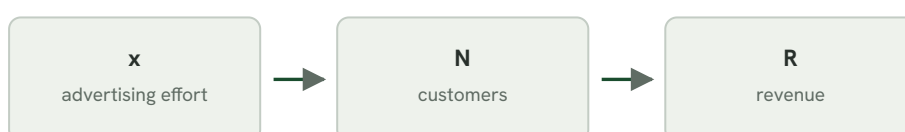
✍ **Practise:** Building the formula · Find composite functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composing/e/compose-functions>)

COMPOSITION

$$(g \circ f)(x) = g(f(x))$$

Do f first, then feed its output straight into g . The circle is read right to left.

- 1 **Work from the inside out.** Compute the inner value, then put it into the outer function.
- 2 **Substitute the whole inner output.** Every x in the outer function becomes the entire inner expression, brackets included.
- 3 **Order matters.** $f \circ g$ is almost never $g \circ f$. Check with one number if you doubt it.
- 4 **For it to exist, the middle value has to be allowed.** $f(x)$ must be something g accepts.
- 5 **The quantity in the middle is real, but the question is not about it.** Advertising gives customers, customers give revenue; the question asks revenue from advertising.



The chain. The middle quantity is real, but the question is not about it.

THE CALCULATION

$$R(N(x)) = 70(100\sqrt{x}) + \frac{(100\sqrt{x})^2}{20}$$

Every n becomes $100\sqrt{x}$, including the one being squared.

$$= 7000\sqrt{x} + 500x$$

Because $(100\sqrt{x})^2 = 10\,000x$ and $\frac{10\,000x}{20} = 500x$.

The definition

$$(g \circ f)(x) = g(f(x))$$

Two properties

ORDER MATTERS: $F(x) = 2x + 1$, $G(x) = x^2 - 3$

$$(g \circ f)(x) = (2x + 1)^2 - 3 = 4x^2 + 4x - 2$$

Write the outer function with an empty bracket, then fill it.

$$(f \circ g)(x) = 2(x^2 - 3) + 1 = 2x^2 - 5$$

The other order.

at $x = 4$: 78 against 27

Same functions, same input, different answers.

WATCH OUT

- $(g \circ f)(x)$ is not $g(x) \cdot f(x)$. The ring is not a multiplication dot.
- The whole inner function goes inside the bracket: $(2p + 1)^2$, never $2p^2 + 1$.
- Take the domain from the two original functions, not from the tidied-up composite.

PRACTICE · COMPOSITION OF FUNCTIONS

1. With $f(x) = x + 1$ and $g(x) = x^2$, what is $(g \circ f)(3)$?

- A. 16
- B. 36
- C. 10
- D. 12

2. $(g \circ f)(x)$ means

- A. $g(f(x))$
- B. $f(g(x))$
- C. $g(x) \cdot f(x)$
- D. $g(x) + f(x)$

3. In $(g \circ f)(x)$, which function acts on x first?

- A. f
- B. g
- C. Both at once
- D. It depends on the formulas

4. Another way of writing $f(g(x))$ is

- A. $f \circ g$
- B. $g \circ f$
- C. $f \cdot g$
- D. $g(f(x))$

5. With $f(x) = 3x - 2$ and $g(x) = x^2$, what is $(g \circ f)(3)$?

6. A table gives $f(1) = 4$, $f(4) = 2$, $g(1) = 5$, $g(4) = 0$. What is $(g \circ f)(1)$?

- A. 0
- B. 5
- C. 2
- D. 4

Inverses, and when one exists

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► **Watch:** What an inverse is · Intro to inverse functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:functions/x2f8bb11595b61c86:inverse-functions-intro/v/introduction-to-function-inverses>)

► **Watch:** When one exists · Invertible functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:invertible/v/determining-if-a-function-is-invertible>)

≡ **Read:** One-to-one, written out · Intro to invertible functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:invertible/a/intro-to-invertible-functions>)

✍ **Practise:** Spotting when there is no inverse · Determine if a function is invertible (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:invertible/e/inverse-domain-range>)

✍ **Practise:** Reading an inverse off a graph · Inverse functions: graphs and tables (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:inverse-functions-in-graphs-and-tables/e/inverse-functions-graphs-and-tables>)

INVERSE

The function that sends each output back to the input it came from.

$$f(f^{-1}(x)) = f^{-1}(f(x)) = x$$

ONE-TO-ONE

Different inputs always give different outputs. No output is ever produced twice.

- 1 **A function has an inverse exactly when it is one-to-one.** That is the whole condition.
- 2 **On a graph, the horizontal line test decides.** A horizontal line may meet the graph at most once. Twice means two inputs share an output, so there is no way back.
- 3 **Strictly increasing or strictly decreasing is enough.** A function that only ever rises, or only ever falls, is one-to-one.
- 4 **The domain and the range swap.** The inverse's inputs are the original's outputs.
- 5 **The graph of the inverse is the reflection in the line $y = x$.**

WATCH OUT

- An inverse is not a reciprocal. $f^{-1}(x)$ is not $\frac{1}{f(x)}$.
- A function that repeats an output has no inverse, because there is no way back to which input it came from.
- Swapping the domain and the range is part of the answer, not an afterthought.

$$Q(p) = \frac{50\,000\,000}{p + 1} - 5\,000\,000 \quad \text{for } 0 \leq p \leq 9$$

THE DERIVATION

$$q = \frac{50\,000\,000}{p + 1} - 5\,000\,000$$

Start from the definition.

$$q + 5\,000\,000 = \frac{50\,000\,000}{p + 1}$$

Move the constant across.

$$p + 1 = \frac{50\,000\,000}{q + 5\,000\,000}$$

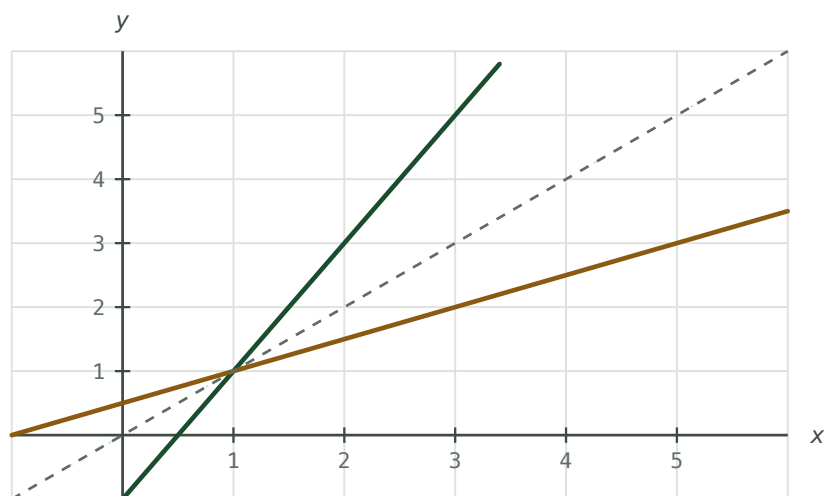
Take reciprocals of both sides.

$$P(q) = \frac{50\,000\,000}{q + 5\,000\,000} - 1$$

The price as a function of the quantity.

The definition and the check

$$f(f^{-1}(x)) = f^{-1}(f(x)) = x$$



$f(x) = 2x - 1$ and its inverse, mirrored in the dashed line $y = x$.

PRACTICE · INVERSES, AND WHEN ONE EXISTS

1. What is the inverse of $f(x) = 5x + 3$?

A. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x - 3}{5}$

B. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x + 3}{5}$

C. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x}{5} - 3$

D. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{1}{5x + 3}$

2. Which of these functions has **no** inverse on all of $\mathbb{R}$?

A. $f(x) = x^2$

B. $f(x) = 2x + 1$

C. $f(x) = x^3$

D. $f(x) = -4x + 7$

3. On the restricted domain $x \geq 0$, what is the inverse of $f(x) = x^2$?

A. $f^{-1}(x) = \sqrt{x}$, for $x \geq 0$

B. $f^{-1}(x) = \pm\sqrt{x}$

C. $f^{-1}(x) = -\sqrt{x}$

D. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{1}{x^2}$

4. For $f(x) = 5x + 3$, what is $f^{-1}(38)$?

5. Find the inverse of $p(q) = \frac{3}{q - 4} + 5$.

A. $q(p) = \frac{3}{p - 5} + 4$

B. $q(p) = \frac{3}{p + 5} + 4$

C. $q(p) = \frac{3}{p - 5} - 4$

D. $q(p) = \frac{p - 5}{3} + 4$

6. Find the inverse of $f(x) = \sqrt{x - 1} + 2$, defined for $x \geq 1$, and state its domain.

A. $f^{-1}(x) = (x - 2)^2 + 1$, for $x \geq 2$

B. $f^{-1}(x) = (x - 2)^2 + 1$, for every real x

C. $f^{-1}(x) = (x + 2)^2 + 1$, for $x \geq -2$

D. $f^{-1}(x) = (x - 1)^2 + 2$, for $x \geq 1$

Finding an inverse

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► **Watch:** Finding one, step by step · Finding inverse functions: linear (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:functions/x2f8bb11595b61c86:inverse-functions-intro/v/function-inverse-example-1>)

► **Watch:** Checking it · Verifying inverse functions by composition (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:verifying-inverse/v/verify-inverse-functions-from-tables>)

≡ **Read:** The method, written out · Intro to inverse functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:functions/x2f8bb11595b61c86:inverse-functions-intro/a/intro-to-inverse-functions>)

✍ **Practise:** Finding one · Find inverses of linear functions (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra/x2f8bb11595b61c86:functions/x2f8bb11595b61c86:inverse-functions-intro/e/algebraically-finding-inverses>)

✍ **Practise:** Checking by composition · Verify inverse functions (https://www.khanacademy.org/math/precalculus/x9e81a4f98389efdf:composite/x9e81a4f98389efdf:verifying-inverse/e/inverses_of_functions)

- 1 Write $y = f(x)$.
- 2 Solve for x in terms of y . This is the only step that is real work.
- 3 Swap the names. x goes back to being the input, so the answer is written as a function of x .
- 4 Check by composing both ways. You should get x back each time. This catches almost every slip.
- 5 If it is not one-to-one, restrict the domain until it is. $f(x) = (x - 1)^2$ has no inverse until you keep only $x \geq 1$.
- 6 The linear case is worth knowing by sight.

$$f(x) = ax + b \quad \Rightarrow \quad f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x - b}{a}$$

- 7 To solve $f(x) = k$, apply the inverse to both sides. That is what an inverse is for.

Finding one, and when it exists

THE GENERAL LINEAR CASE: $F(X) = AX + B$

$$g(x) = \frac{x - b}{a}$$

Undo in reverse order: subtract b , then divide by a .

$$f(g(x)) = a \frac{x - b}{a} + b = x$$

Check one way.

$$g(f(x)) = \frac{(ax + b) - b}{a} = x$$

And the other. So it is the inverse, and it is linear too.

Using an inverse to solve an equation

WATCH OUT

- $f^{-1}(x)$ is the inverse function, not $\frac{1}{f(x)}$.
- A function that fails the horizontal line test has no inverse until its domain is restricted.
- Domain and range swap. If you are asked for the domain of the inverse, look at the range of the original.

PRACTICE · FINDING AN INVERSE

1. What is the inverse of $f(x) = 5x + 3$?

- A. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x - 3}{5}$
- B. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x + 3}{5}$
- C. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{x}{5} - 3$
- D. $f^{-1}(x) = \frac{1}{5x + 3}$

2. Which of these functions has **no** inverse on all of $\mathbb{R}$?

- A. $f(x) = x^2$
- B. $f(x) = 2x + 1$
- C. $f(x) = x^3$
- D. $f(x) = -4x + 7$

3. On the restricted domain $x \geq 0$, what is the inverse of $f(x) = x^2$?

A. $f^{-1}(x) = \sqrt{x}$, for $x \geq 0$

B. $f^{-1}(x) = \pm\sqrt{x}$

C. $f^{-1}(x) = -\sqrt{x}$

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4. For $f(x) = 5x + 3$, what is $f^{-1}(38)$?

5. Find the inverse of $p(q) = \frac{3}{q-4} + 5$.

A. $q(p) = \frac{3}{p-5} + 4$

B. $q(p) = \frac{3}{p+5} + 4$

C. $q(p) = \frac{3}{p-5} - 4$

D. $q(p) = \frac{p-5}{3} + 4$

6. Find the inverse of $f(x) = \sqrt{x-1} + 2$, defined for $x \geq 1$, and state its domain.

A. $f^{-1}(x) = (x-2)^2 + 1$, for $x \geq 2$

B. $f^{-1}(x) = (x-2)^2 + 1$, for every real x

C. $f^{-1}(x) = (x+2)^2 + 1$, for $x \geq -2$

D. $f^{-1}(x) = (x-1)^2 + 2$, for $x \geq 1$

The rules of logarithms

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- ▶ **Watch:** The logarithm rules · Intro to logarithm properties (1 of 2) (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra2/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:logs/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:log-prop/v/introduction-to-logarithm-properties>)
- ▶ **Watch:** The rule that solves equations · Using the logarithmic power rule (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra2/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:logs/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:log-prop/v/logarithm-of-a-power>)
- ▶ **Watch:** The change of base formula for logarithms (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra2/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:logs/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:change-of-base/v/change-of-base-formula>)
- ≡ **Read:** The rules, written out · Intro to logarithm properties (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra2/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:logs/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:log-prop/a/properties-of-logarithms>)
- ✍ **Practise:** Expanding and condensing · Use the properties of logarithms (https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra2/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:logs/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:log-prop/e/logarithms_2)
- ✍ **Practise:** Evaluate logarithms: change of base rule (<https://www.khanacademy.org/math/algebra2/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:logs/x2ec2f6f830c9fb89:change-of-base/e/evaluate-logarithms-using-the-change-of-base-rule>)

THE THREE THAT EXIST

$$\log(ab) = \log a + \log b \quad \log \frac{a}{b} = \log a - \log b \quad \log(a^n) = n \log a$$

THE ONE THAT DOES NOT

There is no rule for $\log(a + b)$. It does not simplify. Nothing you do turns a sum inside a logarithm into anything shorter.

- 1 **Expanding:** a product becomes a sum, a quotient a difference, a power a coefficient.
- 2 **Simplifying:** the same three rules read right to left.
- 3 **The power rule** is the one that solves equations. It brings the unknown down out of the exponent where you can reach it.
- 4 **Change the base** when the calculator has not got it.

$$\log_b x = \frac{\ln x}{\ln b}$$

- 5 The exponential and the logarithm undo each other.

$$\exp(\ln u) = u \quad a^x = \exp(x \ln a) \quad \text{for } a > 0$$

- 6 Check the argument is positive before applying any of it.

Exponents

RULE

$$b^x \cdot b^y = b^{x+y}$$

$$(b^x)^y = b^{xy}$$

$$\left(\frac{b}{c}\right)^x = \frac{b^x}{c^x}$$

$$b^0 = 1$$

RULE

$$\frac{b^x}{b^y} = b^{x-y}$$

$$(bc)^x = b^x c^x$$

$$b^1 = b$$

$$b^{-x} = \frac{1}{b^x}$$

Logarithms

RULE

$$\log_b(mn) = \log_b m + \log_b n$$

$$\log_b(m^r) = r \log_b m$$

$$\log_b 1 = 0$$

$$\log_b m = \frac{\log_a m}{\log_a b}$$

RULE

$$\log_b \frac{m}{n} = \log_b m - \log_b n$$

$$\log_b \frac{1}{m} = -\log_b m$$

$$\log_b b = 1$$

change of base

Expanding

WRITING LOGARITHMS IN TERMS OF SIMPLER LOGARITHMS

$$\ln \frac{x}{zw} = \ln x - \ln(zw)$$

Quotient rule first.

$$= \ln x - \ln z - \ln w$$

Then the product rule, and the minus reaches both.

$$\ln \sqrt[3]{x^5(x-2)^8 \div (x-3)^3} \rightarrow \frac{1}{3} [5 \ln x + 8 \ln(x-2) - \ln(x-3)]$$

A cube root is a power of one third, so the whole bracket is scaled by it.

Simplifying

WORKED EXAMPLES

$$\ln e^{3x} = 3x$$

The two undo each other.

$$\log 1 + \log 1000 = 0 + 3 = 3$$

$$1000 = 10^3.$$

$$\log_7 \sqrt[9]{7^8} = \frac{8}{9}$$

$$\text{Because } \sqrt[9]{7^8} = 7^{8/9}.$$

$$\log_3 \frac{27}{81} = \log_3 \frac{1}{3} = -1$$

$$\frac{3^3}{3^4} = 3^{-1}.$$

$$\ln e + \log \frac{1}{10} = 1 + (-1) = 0$$

Both special values.

In summary

$$\exp(\ln u) = u \quad \ln(\exp x) = x \quad \exp(x) = u \Leftrightarrow x = \ln u$$

$$a^x = \exp(x \ln a) \text{ for } a > 0$$

WATCH OUT

- $\log(a + b)$ does not break up. There is no rule for the logarithm of a sum.
- $\frac{\log a}{\log b}$ is not $\log(a - b)$, and $(\log a)^2$ is not $2 \log a$.
- Isolate the exponential before taking logarithms, and reject any answer that makes an original logarithm take a non-positive input.

PRACTICE · THE RULES OF LOGARITHMS

1. Write $(b^3)^4 \cdot b^{-2}$ as a single power of b .

A. b^{10}

B. b^5

C. b^{14}

D. b^{24}

2. Compute $\log_2 8 + \log_2 4$.

3. Write $\ln(x^3y)$ in terms of $\ln x$ and $\ln y$, for $x > 0$ and $y > 0$.

- A. $3 \ln x + \ln y$
- B. $3 \ln x \cdot \ln y$
- C. $\ln(3x) + \ln y$
- D. $3(\ln x + \ln y)$

4. Only one of these is always valid. Which one?

- A. $\ln(ab) = \ln a + \ln b$
- B. $\ln(a + b) = \ln a + \ln b$
- C. $\ln a \cdot \ln b = \ln(ab)$
- D. $\frac{\ln a}{\ln b} = \ln(a - b)$

5. A student writes three lines. Line 1: $\ln\left(\frac{x^2 + 4}{x}\right) = \ln(x^2 + 4) - \ln x$. Line 2: $\ln(x^2 + 4) = \ln(x^2) + \ln 4$. Line 3: $\ln(x^2) = 2 \ln x$, for $x > 0$. Which line is invalid?

- A. Line 2 only.
- B. Line 1 only.
- C. Line 3 only.
- D. All three are valid.

6. For which values of x is $\ln(x^2) = 2 \ln x$ correct?

- A. $x > 0$
- B. every $x \neq 0$
- C. every real x
- D. $x \geq 0$

Week 2 review quiz

Six questions in the Cyberlearn format. The operations, composition and inverses from this week, with the distractors the usual mistakes produce.

PRACTICE · WEEK 2 REVIEW QUIZ

1. Let $f(x) = x^2 + 1$, $g(x) = 8x$ and $h(x) = \sqrt{x + 3}$. Compute $(f - g + h)(6)$.

- A. -8
- B. 8
- C. -14
- D. 82
- E. None of the above

2. Let $f(x) = x^2 - 2x$ and $g(x) = 4x - 1$. Compute $(g \circ f)(x)$.

- A. $4x^2 - 8x - 1$
- B. $4x^2 - 2x - 1$
- C. $16x^2 - 8x + 1$
- D. $x^2 - 2x - 1$
- E. None of the above

3. Let $p(q) = (q - 3)^3 + 2$. Compute the inverse.

- A. $q(p) = \sqrt[3]{p - 2} + 3$
- B. $q(p) = \sqrt[3]{p + 2} + 3$
- C. $q(p) = (p - 2)^3 + 3$
- D. $q(p) = \sqrt[3]{p - 3} + 2$
- E. None of the above

4. Let $p(q) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{q + 5}} + 4$. Compute the inverse.

- A. $q(p) = \frac{1}{(p - 4)^2} - 5$
- B. $q(p) = \frac{1}{(p + 4)^2} - 5$
- C. $q(p) = (p - 4)^2 - 5$
- D. $q(p) = \frac{1}{(p - 4)^2} + 5$
- E. None of the above

5. What are the intercepts of $y = 3x - 12$?

- A. x-intercept -12 , y-intercept 4
- B. x-intercept -4 , y-intercept 12
- C. x-intercept 12 , y-intercept 3
- D. x-intercept 4 , y-intercept 12
- E. None of the above

6. Compute $\log_2 32 - \log_2 4$.

- A. 3
- B. 8
- C. $\log_2 28$
- D. 28
- E. None of the above

Answers

1. Adding and multiplying functions

- | | | |
|------------|---------|------|
| 1. -15.0 | 3. A | 5. A |
| 2. 26000.0 | 4. 50.0 | 6. A |

2. Reading a graph

- | | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------|--------|
| 1. $(0, -6), (0; -6), 0; -6, (0, -6)$ | 3. 1.0 | 5. A |
| 2. A | 4. A | 6. 4.5 |

3. Composition of functions

- | | | |
|------|------|---------|
| 1. A | 3. A | 5. 49.0 |
| 2. A | 4. A | 6. A |

4. Inverses, and when one exists

- | | | |
|------|--------|------|
| 1. A | 3. A | 5. A |
| 2. A | 4. 7.0 | 6. A |

5. Finding an inverse

- | | | |
|------|--------|------|
| 1. A | 3. A | 5. A |
| 2. A | 4. 7.0 | 6. A |

6. The rules of logarithms

- | | | |
|--------|------|------|
| 1. A | 3. A | 5. A |
| 2. 5.0 | 4. A | 6. A |

7. Week 2 review quiz

- | | | |
|------|------|------|
| 1. A | 3. A | 5. E |
| 2. A | 4. A | 6. A |



Quantitative Methods I. Notes I wrote while learning this. Free to use and to share.

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